

2011: Ninth hottest year

According to NASA and NOAA, 2011 was the 9th hottest year on record since the last 130 years. It's getting hot in here! <http://1.usa.gov/wRjBGU>

ReFS, a new file system

Meet the successor of NTFS called ReFS, standard in Windows 8. Read more about it on our web site <http://dvwx.in/feb12-refs>



Ryan Seacrest and Steve Ballmer, Microsoft's CEO, at the company's final CES keynote

Microsoft's last hurrah!

Microsoft delivered its last official opening keynote at CES 2012, a tradition spanning back to 1995 when Bill Gates took the floor all those years ago. Steve Ballmer demonstrated, ably aided by senior Microsoft executives, the latest developments in Windows 8, Windows Phone and Xbox Kinect teams, leaving no doubt about the three key focus areas for the Redmond-based software giant in 2012.

In a sold-out Venetian ballroom, Microsoft CEO Steve Ballmer famously reprised his “developers, developers, developers,” call to arms from 2006 by stating the way ahead for Microsoft was “Windows, Windows, Windows!” Derek Snyder, from the Windows Phone team, wasted no time in providing a demo for Windows Phone with the newly launched Nokia Lumia N900 (the HTC Titan 2 was also spotted on the podium). He spoke about the people hub,

metro UI, Facebook and Bing integration, among other things. Tami Reller, Chief Marketing Officer, Windows team, delivered a detailed demo of the upcoming Windows 8 operating system and its unique features. She also reiterated that Windows 8 would run on both, x86 and ARM chipsets. She further went on to showcase two new ultrabooks: the HP Envy 14 Spectra and Samsung Series 9 15-inch ultrabook.

She was finally followed by Craig Davison from Microsoft's Xbox team, who demonstrated the fresh new metro UI of Xbox LIVE and its improved voice search through Kinect. She also demonstrated that the Xbox LIVE can be used via a Windows Phone, in this case the new Nokia Lumia N900. Kinect 2-way TV with Sesame Street was also showcased, highlighting the potential of creating interactive TV entertainment where users engage with the TV content like never before. Find these videos on this month's DVD and images at <http://bit.ly/yнкMql>.



Tami Reller with a prototype Win8 tablet



At Microsoft's booth at CES 2012

Ultrabook, PC announcements galore

1 HP unveiled its first ultrabook – the HP Envy 14 Spectre: Features of the HP Envy 14 Spectre include a 14-inch 1600x900 pixel resolution display, Intel Core i5-2467M processor, 4 GB of RAM, a 128GB SSD, and a 9-hour battery life. <http://bit.ly/wR1SXX>

2 Samsung highlighted refreshed Series 9 laptops:

The new 13-inch model measures 13 mm in thickness and weighs in at 1.1 kg, while the 15-inch weighs 1.6 kgs and measures 15 mm in thickness. <http://bit.ly/yduIle>

3 Lenovo released host of IdeaPad ultrabooks, netbooks:

New products in the IdeaPad U Series, Y Series, S Series and Z Series provide a full spectrum of styles, colours and performance for every consumer. <http://bit.ly/yJfuwC>

4 Dell launched XPS 13 ultrabook: Will start at \$999 with an Intel Core i5 processor and 128GB solid-state drive. The elegance includes a CNC-machined aluminum display backbonded to the 13.3-inch LCD, which in turn is bonded to an edge-to-edge Corning Gorilla Glass cover for less flex and more durability. <http://bit.ly/zBjLJz>

5 Acer announced world's slimmest ultrabook: The new Acer Aspire S5 measures just 15 mm

(0.59 inches) and sports a 13.3-inch LCD display. It weighs just 2.97 pounds. The Aspire S5 ultrabook will be available in the second quarter of 2012. <http://bit.ly/wF1CxT>